

Even though these implications don't exactly spell doom for the Chinese economy considering the scale at which it operates at the domestic level, and the fact that not every manufacturer will end up adopting localised 3D printing, the respect the Chinese command at present as the manufacturing powerhouse of the world might not help them in the future.

While some feel that 3D printing is going to close down shops across the world, what the 3D printer lacks is the fact that the production of moveable parts is still yet to be made possible and the process followed for printing an object.

Back to reality

While 3D printing may be the future, it still has a way to go before the kinks are ironed out. For starters, the idea of one day being able to print out large replacement parts for home appliances is still an idea and experts feel that it would at least be a decade before such technology enters the market let alone becomes cost effective.

The time taken to print a ring or a pair of dog tags may be short but the amount of time a professional grade 3D printer would take to make say the chassis of a DSLR or any other complex item for that matter would run into days.



It's beautiful!

While the 3D printer you have at home makes objects that are almost ready for use, it would still require a certain amount of work before it's ready. Add to this the fact that a 3D printer can print objects on only one colour; the translucent red dog tags don't look enticing anymore.

Add to this the fact that conventional production methods can handle a variety of raw materials and the size of the print area isn't much either, 3D printing will still need some time to come of age.

Furthermore our reliance on a lot of natural products would actually keep the traditional means of production alive and in attempts to go green; we would be embracing bamboo and fungi as viable materials and not 3D printers. Unless somebody figures out a way to print them. 